

## The Unknown Tower and Halls

By Steven K Allen

[Scorge30@hotmail.com](mailto:Scorge30@hotmail.com)

This Forgotten Realms adventure is designed for a party of four to six characters of ninth to twelfth levels (about 50 total levels). Due to the amount of magic and traps present within the adventure, the party should include at least one mage and thief. Several of the rooms are near geothermal regions creating temperatures near the maximum of human endurance. Lacking sufficient magic to protect themselves from such extremes of temperature, the characters could suffer damage from dehydration and exposure to extreme high temperatures followed by ambient underground temperatures. The DM may desire to use alternate rules for tracking the characters exposure to high and low temperatures and dehydration as there are no sources of water within the complex. Although there are several Drow NPCs within the adventure, the party does not have to include a Drow character, but a party comprised of character races or types tolerant of Drow works best. The book I, Tyrant would be useful for obtaining an exact understanding of the gauth, but is not necessary for play. The book Drow of the Underdark details the drow deities and explains renegade drow, and material for this adventure was drawn largely from this volume so a copy should be available for the DM but the adventure can be ran without it. Several creatures are taken from the Greyhawk Adventures and Forgotten Realms Monstrous Compendium Appendixes, although this adventure is not set within Oerth. The DM lacking these volumes might substitute creatures suitable to his campaign. The magical candles taken from Dragon Magazine #147 "Magic for Beginners" by Gregory W. Detwiler and Dragon Magazine #179 "Unique Magical Candles for Your Campaign" by Gregg Chamberlain can be substituted for other magical items suitable to the DM's campaign. The dread portals taken from Dragon Magazine #102 "Open Them if You Dare" by Ed Greenwood may be substituted for other portals suitable to the DM's campaign. The god Goibhnie<sup>1</sup> is from the Celtic mythos found in the original hardback book Deities and Demigods<sup>2</sup>, his worshippers are predominately blacksmiths that fervently seek out all forms of weapons. Temples and shrines dedicated to Goibhnie are often filled with weapons left as offerings, and a devout worshipper or one desiring the deity's favor may even leave a magical weapon.

The city of Bartlesville<sup>3</sup> purposely left vague allowing the DM to drop this adventure into an existing Forgotten Realms campaign, and is intended to be somewhere in the North. The city's predominately human population is about 1,500. Its major industries are smithing, fur trading, wagon and barrel making, and leather production. This city boasts the largest temple in the Realms dedicated to the god Goibhnie, the blacksmith of the gods. Flanking this temple are two temples dedicated to the other two deities that comprise the triad craftsman-gods, Luchta and Creidhne.

### For the Players:

Read or paraphrase the following to the players:

While traveling through the small trading city of Bartlesville, you hear a town crier announcing that the temple of Goibhnie is seeking to hire adventurers to complete the search of a nearby ruined tower. While listening to the crier's sales pitch, it seems as if this tower was recently discovered, partially searched and a large amount of gold was sighted but unrecovered. However, a magical sword was recovered and now rests in the temple of Goibhnie's treasury. Interested adventuring bands are directed to see Gharri of Goibhnie, the high priest of Goibhnie in Bartlesville.

The town crier making the announcements is doing exactly what he has been paid to do. He has no further information and does not make any more money if someone volunteers to perform this adventure. Pumping him for information without coin reveals nothing, but a few silver pieces reveals that a small mounted patrol of about seven fighters from the city were attacked by a large group of orcs. Fleeing from the orcs, with several members wounded, they accidentally discovered this ruined tower. Only three members of the patrol returned to the city, bearing a magical, glowing sword taken from the tower. The survivors were healed in the temple of Goibhnie, and told some wild rumors about a "floating, many-eyed, round glowing beast with a gaping mouth full of fangs that slew several of the fighters and chased the survivors from the tower." Somehow, they managed to elude the orcs and made it back to the city.

### For the DM:

When the patrol fled from the orcs into the tower, they discovered the gauth, the unwitting door guard for a small band of renegade drow. The third floor of the ruined tower contains a magical teleporting mirror to a fixed location in the Underdark. The mirror is hidden within an extra dimensional space and the drow know the command word to recall it. The renegade drow are using the area near the destination the mirror teleports to, and know of the gauth, although the gauth does not know of the drow, nor is it aware of the mirror. Madame Nova, a female fighter/mage/cleric of Vhaeraun<sup>4</sup> leads the drow, and although Vhaeraun is predominately worshipped by males, Madame Nova has displayed excellent service to the deity and he has seen fit to grant the woman spells in his service. These drow although of evil alignments if approached peacefully and respectfully, will gladly trade information with the characters and even some minor articles as decided by the DM. The orcs knew that a terrible creature lived within the tower and were not foolish enough to risk their lives, and figured that the creature would destroy the patrol and left. Unless the DM desires, the orcs are not part of this adventure.

The DM should make this adventure seem like a straight "bug hunt and kill" adventure and should not dissuade the players from making assumptions about the gauth. Most likely they will assume it is a beholder, and may make preparations for encountering a beholder which may not help them much against a gauth. Gauth are particularly

## The Unknown Tower and Halls

By Steven K Allen

[Scorge30@hotmail.com](mailto:Scorge30@hotmail.com)

dangerous to mages, and some of the experts believe that these beholder-kin were bred to deal with mages threatening a hive. The particular gauth in this tower is a solitary beholder-kin, but is otherwise a normal example of his species. The tower was once the home of a reclusive mage and when the gauth moved in, there were enough magical items to keep it fed. Lately the magical items have been running low, and the gauth is hunting the nearby forest and road for items to eat. The renegade drow occasionally “drop” a magical item for the gauth to eat hoping to retain their door guard. The drow only occasionally use this entrance because of the danger of the gauth and keep it for emergencies.

### The Temple of Goibhnie

The temple lay out and description should be modified to fit the DM’s campaign. Some suggestions for decorations are groves of apple, oak and yew trees (far from the buildings, the vapors can stun people), flocks of guardian geese and magic item retrieving ducks<sup>5</sup>, casks or offerings of various food stuffs and perhaps a few snakes (a symbol of fertility to the ancient Celts<sup>6</sup>). The clergy of Goibhnie specialize in the crafting of exceptionally fine weapons. Those weapons that are not magical receive a +1 to both damage and to strike due to their exceptional balance<sup>7</sup>. For church members of high status and for the slaying of dreadful enemies, the clergy of Goibhnie specialize in the crafting of soul eating weapons, and weapons of wounding. These are almost exclusively for use by church members and almost unheard of outside of the church.

The high priest of Goibhnie is a short balding human male with a large gut and huge arms with rippling muscles and prominent veins. His hands and face bear the tell tale marks of a blacksmith, and his harsh voice is used to screaming over a forge. He is dressed in soot-stained, rough cotton tunic with a thick leather apron, leather trousers, and large leather boots. A thick, braided iron and gold torque<sup>8</sup> encircles his neck. The ends of the torque each have a pair of Janus heads inset with small precious gems where the eyes should be. He introduces himself as Lord High Smith Gharri (Jar-ee) of Goibhnie and motions for the adventurers to take a seat. After taking, a seat behind a scarred and stained plain oak desk he gets immediately to business. If the characters are interested he pulls a simple map from the desk and points to the general location of the tower and explains the temple’s need for the adventurer’s services:

An attack upon one of the city’s mounted patrols by a superior force of orcs happened in the mountains north of the city. Badly wounded, outnumbered, and running for their lives, the orcs chased the patrol for two days. By accident, they came upon a large stone ruined tower set in the center of a small grove of fir trees. Seeking shelter inside, to their amazement, the orcs did not follow them into the tower and soon left never to be seen again.

While searching the tower, the patrol uncovered a small amount of gold coins and a magical, glowing sword on the third floor. Near the sword was a large oak chest that resisted all their efforts to open, and it was their opinion that it is probably magically sealed. They also noted an odd, 10’ diameter vertical hole that went through all three levels of the tower. While standing on the third floor a terrible round beast with several eyes floated up from the basement and attacked, slaying several members immediately. The survivors fled from the tower taking the sword with them. They returned to the city and entered the temple where we healed them and they donated the sword to our treasury, since our faith collects unique weapons.

I would like you to return to the temple, slay this beast if possible, and retrieve any more magical weapons that may be there. Any coin or other magical items retrieved from the ruins are yours to keep, but the temple receives any unique or magical weapons.

Gharri gives the adventurers a simple map to the tower, a rough schematic of the layout of the tower, and explains that the trip to the tower will take about three days. If the adventurers are reluctant to take the adventure, he offers each character 500 gp for completing the task payable upon return with proof of the death of the creature. If they are unable to slay the creature, then a decent description and location earns each character 250 gp. Depending upon the amount of magical items the characters are carrying, Gharri might offer some minor healing magic items like potions, scrolls, or two *Acorns of Healing* (treat as a *Potion of Extra Healing*) per character that accepts this adventure.

High Smith Gharri of Goibhnie: AL LG; AC 6; MV 11; P16; THACO 10; #AT 3/2; Dmg by weapon; S 19 (18/38 without the torque), D 16, C 15, I 16, W 17, Ch 11; ML 15; *Torque of Hill Giant Strength*. Gharri is a cloistered cleric and does not actively keep spells memorized unless traveling. When traveling he wears *Plate Mail* +4 and wields a *Warhammer* +3; spells as befitting the DM’s campaign.

Characters that desire to receive the blessing of Goibhnie may leave an offering of a weapon or coins in the temple. Leaving an offering in all three of the god’s temples incurs the greatest chance of receiving a blessing upon the adventure. The nature of this blessing determined by the DM accord to his campaign, should not make the adventure easier or absolve the players of skillful role-play and problem solving. The characters may remain within the temple for up to three days free of charge preparing for the adventure. Staying longer in the city reveals nothing further about the ruins.

### Travel to the Ruined Tower

## The Unknown Tower and Halls

By Steven K Allen

[Scorge30@hotmail.com](mailto:Scorge30@hotmail.com)

The tower is about three days travel from the city through very mild, temperate terrain. The weather is pleasant, warm and dry without being too hot and the travel is through low rolling hills covered with dense pine and hardwood forests. The DM should roll once per day for random encounters.

### Temperate Forest Random Encounters

|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Wyvern (4): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL NE; AC 3; MV 6, Fl 24(E); HD 7+7; hp 33, 2x35, 41; THAC0 13; #AT 2; Dmg 2-16/1-6 (poison stinger); SA Poison (save vs. poison or die, if save take 1d6 dmg); SZ G; ML Elite (14); XP 1,400. |
| 2  | Wolfwere: Int. High to Exceptional (13-16); AL CE; AC 3; MV 15; HD 5+1; hp 20; THAC0 15; #AT 1; Dmg 2-12 and by weapon; SA Singing brings on lethargy; SD Iron or +1 or better weapon to hit; SZ M; ML Elite (14); XP 1,400.          |
| 3  | Bear, Brown: Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 6; MV 12; HD 5+5; hp 23; THAC0 15; #AT 3; Dmg 1-6/1-6/1-8; SA Hug (2d6); SZ L; ML Average (8-10); XP 420.                                                                            |
| 4  | Dog, Wild (5): Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 7; MV 15; HD 1+1; hp 2x8, 7, 4, 2; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-4; SZ S; ML Unsteady (5-7); XP 35.                                                                                       |
| 5  | Leucrotta, Greater (2): Int. 11-12 Very intelligent; AL NE; AC 4; MV 18; HD 8; hp 30, 35; THAC0 13; #AT 1; see below; Dmg 3d6; see below; SA See Below; SD See Below; SZ L; ML Champion (15-16); XP 2,000.                            |
| 6  | Hobgoblin (8): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 5; MV 9; HD 1+1; hp 7, 3x9, 2x6, 2x3; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35.                                                                |
| 7  | Griffon (2): Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 3; MV 12, Fl 30(C); HD 7; hp 32, 34; THAC0 13; #AT 3; Dmg 1-4/1-4/2-16; SZ L; ML Steady (11-12); XP 650.                                                                             |
| 8  | Skulk: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL CE; AC 7; MV 12; HD 2; hp 5; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon; SA Backstab; SD See below; SZ M; ML Unsteady (5-7); XP 120.                                                            |
| 9  | Troll, Giant: Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 4; MV 12; HD 8; hp 39; THAC0 13; #AT 1; Dmg club (2d6+7); SD Regeneration (2hp/rnd except fire dmg), takes at least 10 pts fire dmg to kill; SZ L; ML Fanatic (17-18); XP 1,400.   |
| 10 | Hippogriff (2): Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 5; MV 18, Fl 36(C); HD 3+3; hp 12, 16; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-6/1-6/1-10; SZ L; ML Average (9); XP 175.                                                                           |

### The Ruined Tower

As you approach the tower, you can see that Gharri spoke correctly when he described the conditions of the tower. The tower itself is a squat square construction made of smooth mortared blocks of native stone. Several parts of the tower have fallen to the ground, and all of the other buildings around the tower's perimeter are destroyed. The four majestic fir trees that surround the tower almost hide it from sight, and it would be easy to miss in the dark without the map. You notice an odd thing; a relatively new crude thatched roof covers the stables, while the rest of the tower seems ancient.

Attached to the tower on the southern side is a large square stable that has a decent roof. In the southern end of the stable shut tightly, are two large iron-reinforced wooden doors. These doors are not locked but are barred from the inside. On the north wall, lying on the ground outside, is a pair of identical doors. There is no light within the tower, although the interior is dimly lit by sunlight filtering in through the arrow slits.

The DM should have the characters make a notice roll, giving rangers and elves a slight bonus, to see if they notice the complete lack of animal noise in the surrounding forest. Searching the perimeter of the tower reveals that about 25 mounted horses entered the area. Only seven horses approached the tower on the northern side. These seven horses were picketed within the trees and did not enter the tower, while their riders did. The other horses milled around the area out side the grove and although some of their riders dismounted (revealing orcish riders<sup>9</sup>), they did not enter the tower or the grove and left soon after.

All dimensions of the tower are 25' square, with a 10' high ceiling unless otherwise noted.

#### T1. Tower First Floor.

The inside of the tower is dimly lit from the outside by sunlight filtering in through the arrow slits. Within the center of the wooden floor is a jagged 10' diameter hole. The wooden ceiling of this room, which is the floor of the room above, has an identical hole. Looking up through the hole reveals that the third floor also has a hole in the floor. The perimeter of the hole is sturdy and the floor will support several characters at once, but not the horses. The hole appears to have been cut with either magic or a large tool, but was not done by force.

A rickety flight of wooden stairs climbing the eastern wall allows access to the upper floors. A small fireplace on the western wall is full of cold ashes and small bits of charred wood. A broken stone-top table lies in the south